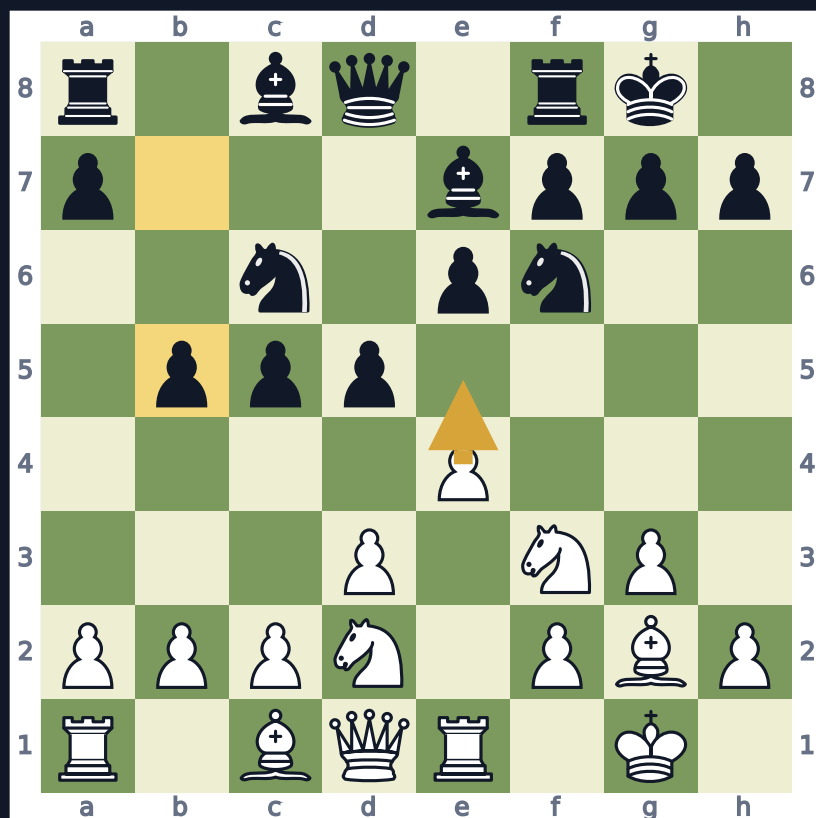


08

The Dark Bishop and Queen Battery

Bf4, Qe2, Qd2, and Bh6: assembling attackers without donating central tempi.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will coordinate the c1 bishop and queen with the pawn storm while recognizing when development matters more than attack.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate White's candidates, find Black's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 043 | PAGE 4

Decode: Bf4 develops with purpose*Develop the bishop to support the next break, not to complete a diagram.*

LESSON 044 | PAGE 8

Play: Bf4 develops with purpose*Develop the bishop to support the next break, not to complete a diagram.*

LESSON 045 | PAGE 12

Decode: Qe2 supports the central rupture*A good queen move serves the center and the king attack at the same time.*

LESSON 046 | PAGE 16

Play: Qe2 supports the central rupture*A good queen move serves the center and the king attack at the same time.*

LESSON 047 | PAGE 20

Decode: Qd2 and Bh6 against a fianchetto*Exchange a king defender only when the squares it guarded can be occupied.*

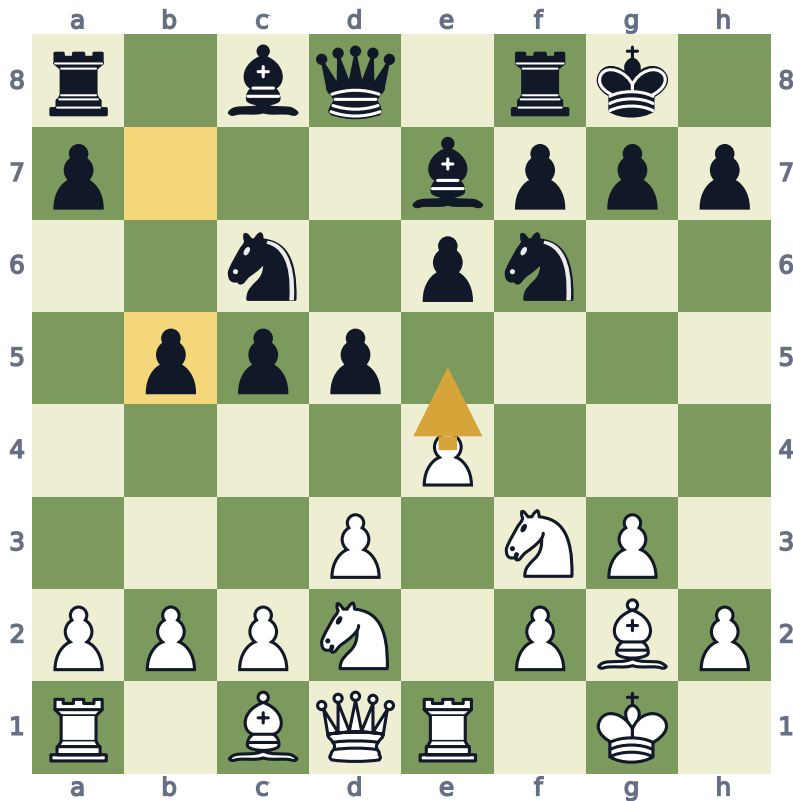
LESSON 048 | PAGE 24

Play: Qd2 and Bh6 against a fianchetto*Exchange a king defender only when the squares it guarded can be occupied.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will coordinate the c1 bishop and queen with the pawn storm while recognizing when development matters more than attack.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Bf4 develops with purpose



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Bf4 develops the last minor piece, supports e5, and eyes d6 or h6, but the bishop can be attacked by ...f6 or ...g5.

DECISION RULE

Which square will the bishop influence after Black's most forcing pawn challenge?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black challenges the bishop with a useful pawn move or uses the tempo to accelerate queenside play.

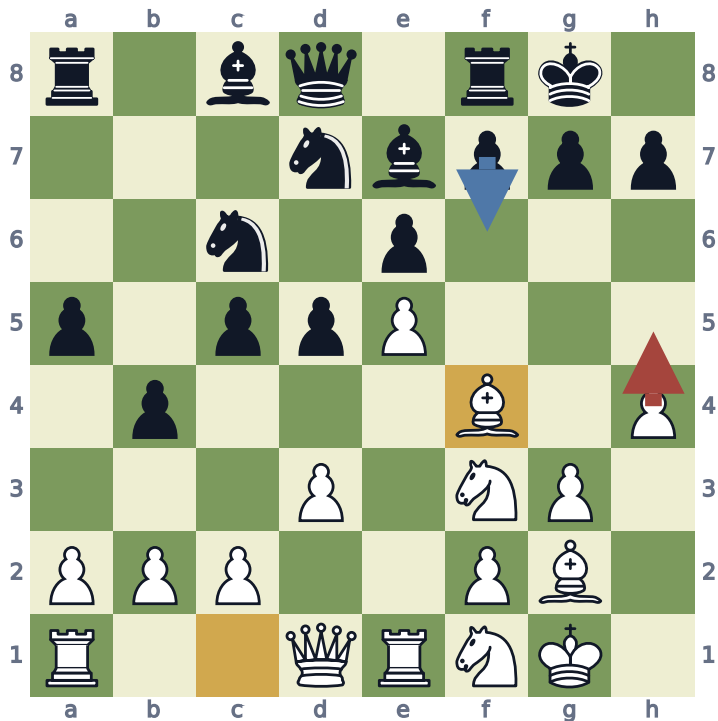
WHITE'S PLAN

White selects f4, g5, or h6 as a destination according to the black pawn structure and queen route.

MEMORY RULE | Develop the bishop to support the next break, not to complete a diagram.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Bf4 develops the last minor piece, supports e5, and eyes d6 or h6, but the bishop can be attacked by ...f6 or ...g5.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black challenges the bishop with a useful pawn move or uses the tempo to accelerate queenside play.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White selects f4, g5, or h6 as a destination according to the black pawn structure and queen route.

FAILURE MODE

Placing the bishop on f4 because it looks active when it can be chased without concession.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which square will the bishop influence after Black's most forcing pawn challenge? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

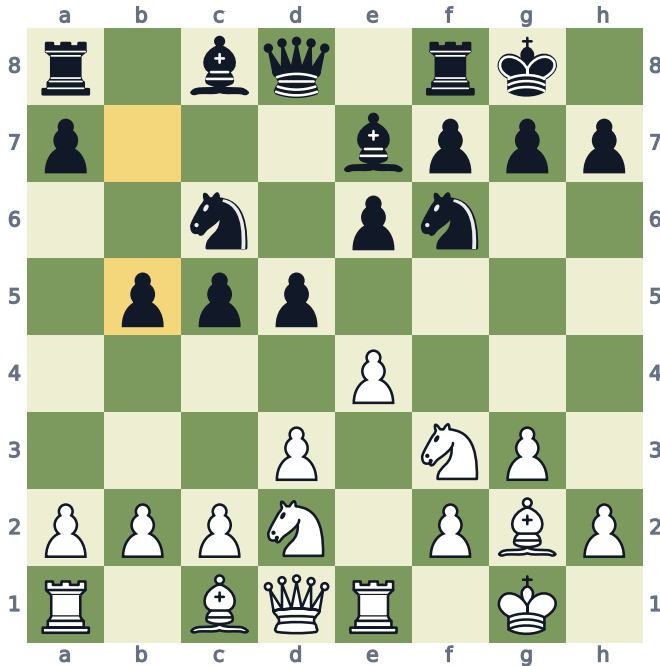
RULE | Develop the bishop to support the next break, not to complete a diagram.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. Bf4



- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Bf4 develops the last minor piece, supports e5, and eyes d6 or h6, but the bishop can be attacked by ...f6 or ...g5.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which square will the bishop influence after Black's most forcing pawn challenge? White's attacking or positional plan is: White selects f4, g5, or h6 as a destination according to the black pawn structure and queen route. The line fails as a template when: Placing the bishop on f4 because it looks active when it can be chased without concession.

STORE THIS | Develop the bishop to support the next break, not to complete a diagram.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

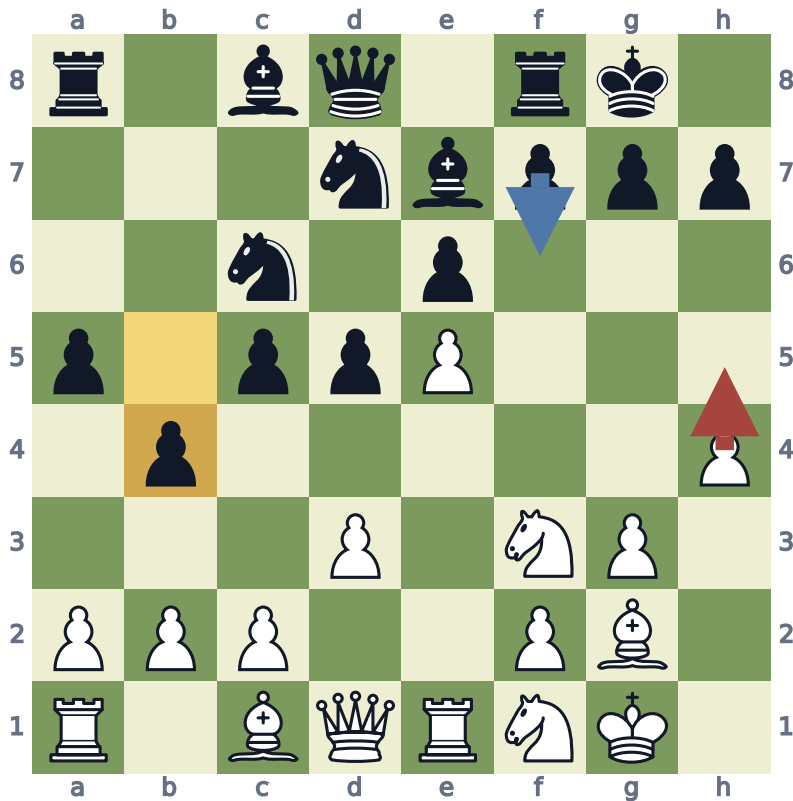
1. Bf4 develops the last minor piece, supports e5, and eyes d6 or h6, but the bishop can be attacked by ...f6 or ...g5. 2. Black challenges the bishop with a useful pawn move or uses the tempo to accelerate queenside play. 3. White selects f4, g5, or h6 as a destination according to the black pawn structure and queen route. 4. Which square will the bishop influence after Black's most forcing pawn challenge? 5. Placing the bishop on f4 because it looks active when it can be chased without concession.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Bf4 develops with purpose



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Bf4 develops the last minor piece, supports e5, and eyes d6 or h6, but the bishop can be attacked by ...f6 or ...g5.

DECISION RULE

Which square will the bishop influence after Black's most forcing pawn challenge?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black challenges the bishop with a useful pawn move or uses the tempo to accelerate queenside play.

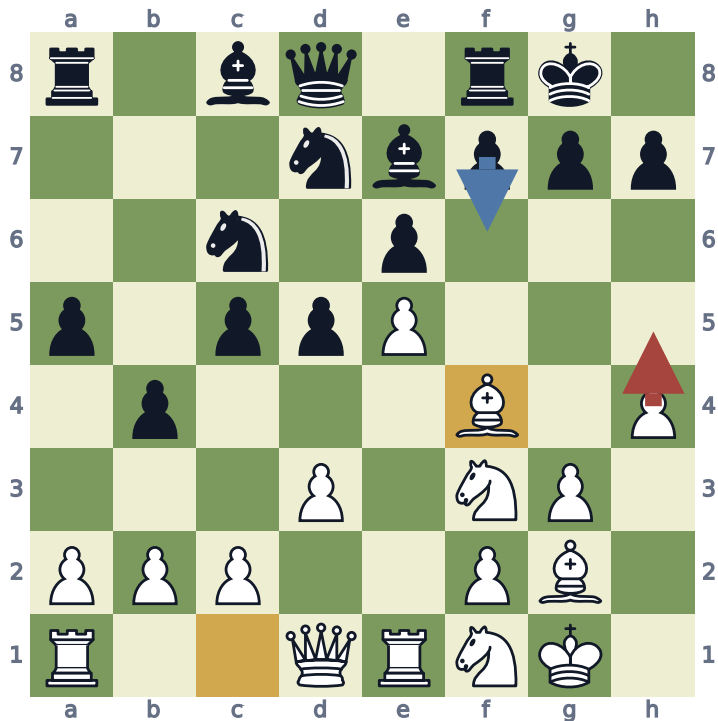
WHITE'S PLAN

White selects f4, g5, or h6 as a destination according to the black pawn structure and queen route.

MEMORY RULE | Develop the bishop to support the next break, not to complete a diagram.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Bf4 develops the last minor piece, supports e5, and eyes d6 or h6, but the bishop can be attacked by ...f6 or ...g5.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black challenges the bishop with a useful pawn move or uses the tempo to accelerate queenside play.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White selects f4, g5, or h6 as a destination according to the black pawn structure and queen route.

FAILURE MODE

Placing the bishop on f4 because it looks active when it can be chased without concession.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which square will the bishop influence after Black's most forcing pawn challenge? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

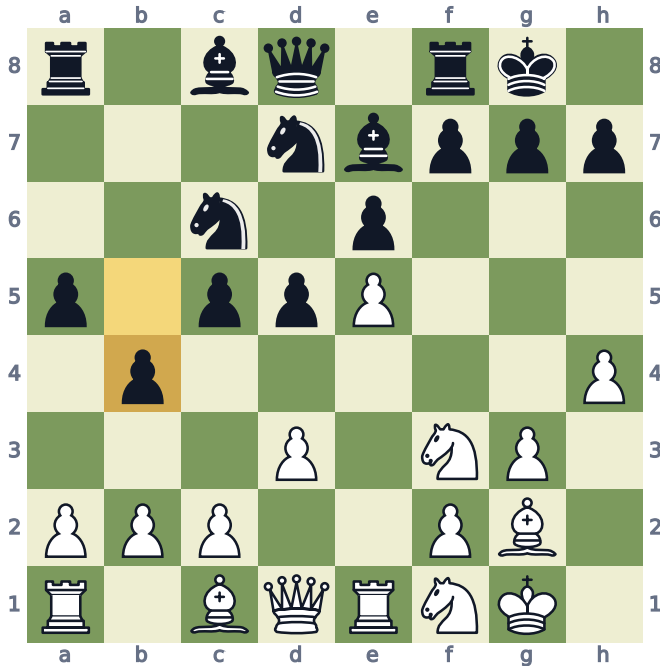
RULE | Develop the bishop to support the next break, not to complete a diagram.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. Bf4



- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- h4: White creates a possible kingside hook and supports h5.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- Nf1: White reroutes a knight to f1; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- b4: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Bf4 develops the last minor piece, supports e5, and eyes d6 or h6, but the bishop can be attacked by ...f6 or ...g5.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which square will the bishop influence after Black's most forcing pawn challenge? White's attacking or positional plan is: White selects f4, g5, or h6 as a destination according to the black pawn structure and queen route. The line fails as a template when: Placing the bishop on f4 because it looks active when it can be chased without concession.

STORE THIS | Develop the bishop to support the next break, not to complete a diagram.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

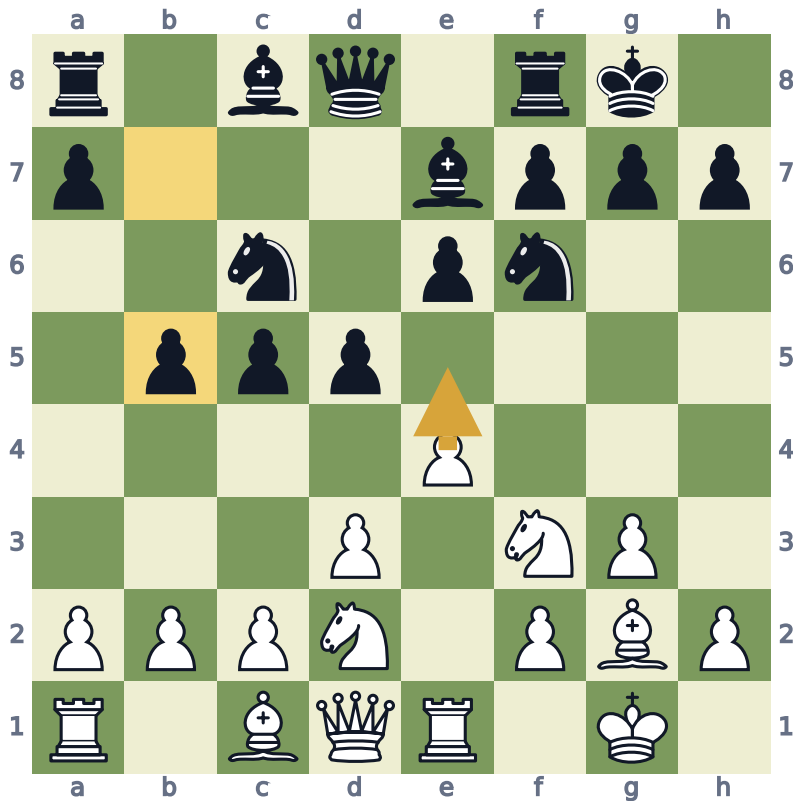
1. Bf4 develops the last minor piece, supports e5, and eyes d6 or h6, but the bishop can be attacked by ...f6 or ...g5. 2. Black challenges the bishop with a useful pawn move or uses the tempo to accelerate queenside play. 3. White selects f4, g5, or h6 as a destination according to the black pawn structure and queen route. 4. Which square will the bishop influence after Black's most forcing pawn challenge? 5. Placing the bishop on f4 because it looks active when it can be chased without concession.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 22 plies from memory, then replay: 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Qe2 supports the central rupture



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Qe2 reinforces e5, connects the rooks, and can reach h5 or g4, while staying behind the e-pawn and away from many minor-piece attacks.

DECISION RULE

Will Qe2 help after ...f6, and which queen route remains safe after the center opens?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black attacks e5 with ...f6, opens the center against the queen, or gains queenside time before it reaches the king.

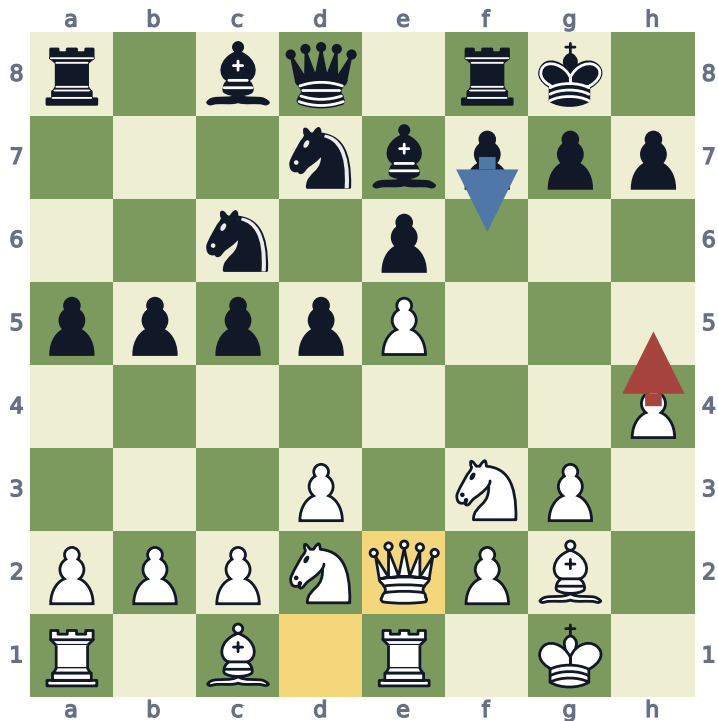
WHITE'S PLAN

White uses Qe2 only when its dual central and attacking roles justify blocking the e-rook's line temporarily.

MEMORY RULE | A good queen move serves the center and the king attack at the same time.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Qe2 reinforces e5, connects the rooks, and can reach h5 or g4, while staying behind the e-pawn and away from many minor-piece attacks.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black attacks e5 with ...f6, opens the center against the queen, or gains queenside time before it reaches the king.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White uses Qe2 only when its dual central and attacking roles justify blocking the e-rook's line temporarily.

FAILURE MODE

Moving the queen toward the attack while the e-file opens against it.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Will Qe2 help after ...f6, and which queen route remains safe after the center opens? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

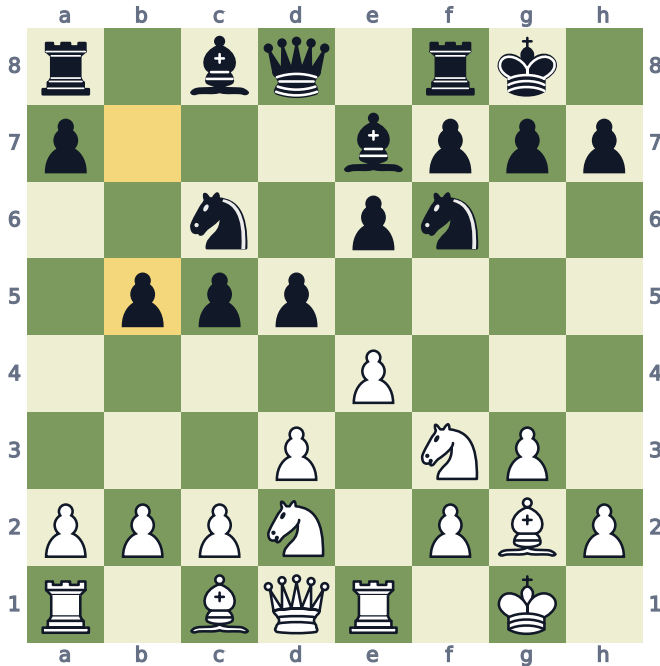
RULE | A good queen move serves the center and the king attack at the same time.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Qe2



- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Qe2 reinforces e5, connects the rooks, and can reach h5 or g4, while staying behind the e-pawn and away from many minor-piece attacks.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Will Qe2 help after ...f6, and which queen route remains safe after the center opens? White's attacking or positional plan is: White uses Qe2 only when its dual central and attacking roles justify blocking the e-rook's line temporarily. The line fails as a template when: Moving the queen toward the attack while the e-file opens against it.

STORE THIS | A good queen move serves the center and the king attack at the same time.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

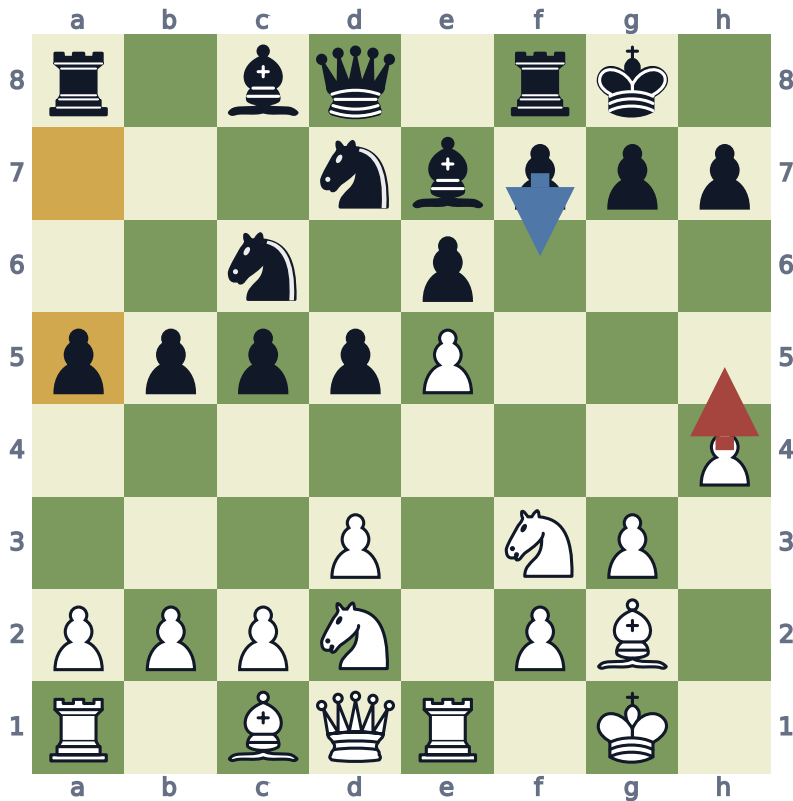
1. Qe2 reinforces e5, connects the rooks, and can reach h5 or g4, while staying behind the e-pawn and away from many minor-piece attacks. 2. Black attacks e5 with ...f6, opens the center against the queen, or gains queenside time before it reaches the king. 3. White uses Qe2 only when its dual central and attacking roles justify blocking the e-rook's line temporarily. 4. Will Qe2 help after ...f6, and which queen route remains safe after the center opens? 5. Moving the queen toward the attack while the e-file opens against it.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Qe2 supports the central rupture



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Qe2 reinforces e5, connects the rooks, and can reach h5 or g4, while staying behind the e-pawn and away from many minor-piece attacks.

DECISION RULE

Will Qe2 help after ...f6, and which queen route remains safe after the center opens?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black attacks e5 with ...f6, opens the center against the queen, or gains queenside time before it reaches the king.

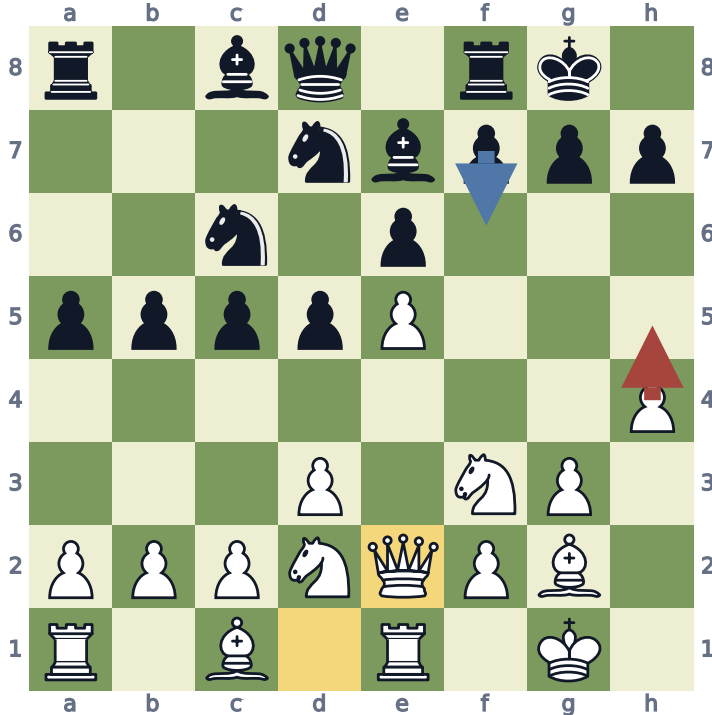
WHITE'S PLAN

White uses Qe2 only when its dual central and attacking roles justify blocking the e-rook's line temporarily.

MEMORY RULE | A good queen move serves the center and the king attack at the same time.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Qe2 reinforces e5, connects the rooks, and can reach h5 or g4, while staying behind the e-pawn and away from many minor-piece attacks.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black attacks e5 with ...f6, opens the center against the queen, or gains queenside time before it reaches the king.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White uses Qe2 only when its dual central and attacking roles justify blocking the e-rook's line temporarily.

FAILURE MODE

Moving the queen toward the attack while the e-file opens against it.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Will Qe2 help after ...f6, and which queen route remains safe after the center opens? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

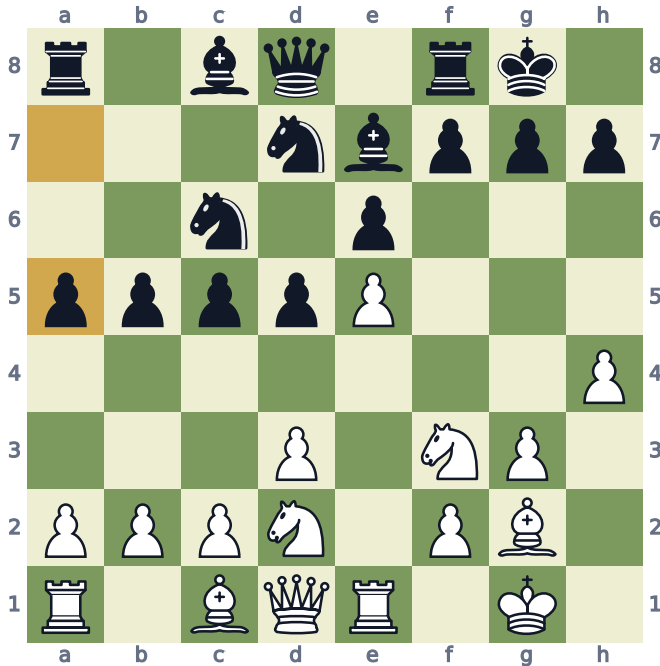
RULE | A good queen move serves the center and the king attack at the same time.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Qe2



- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.
- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- h4: White creates a possible kingside hook and supports h5.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Qe2 reinforces e5, connects the rooks, and can reach h5 or g4, while staying behind the e-pawn and away from many minor-piece attacks.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Will Qe2 help after ...f6, and which queen route remains safe after the center opens? White's attacking or positional plan is: White uses Qe2 only when its dual central and attacking roles justify blocking the e-rook's line temporarily. The line fails as a template when: Moving the queen toward the attack while the e-file opens against it.

STORE THIS | A good queen move serves the center and the king attack at the same time.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

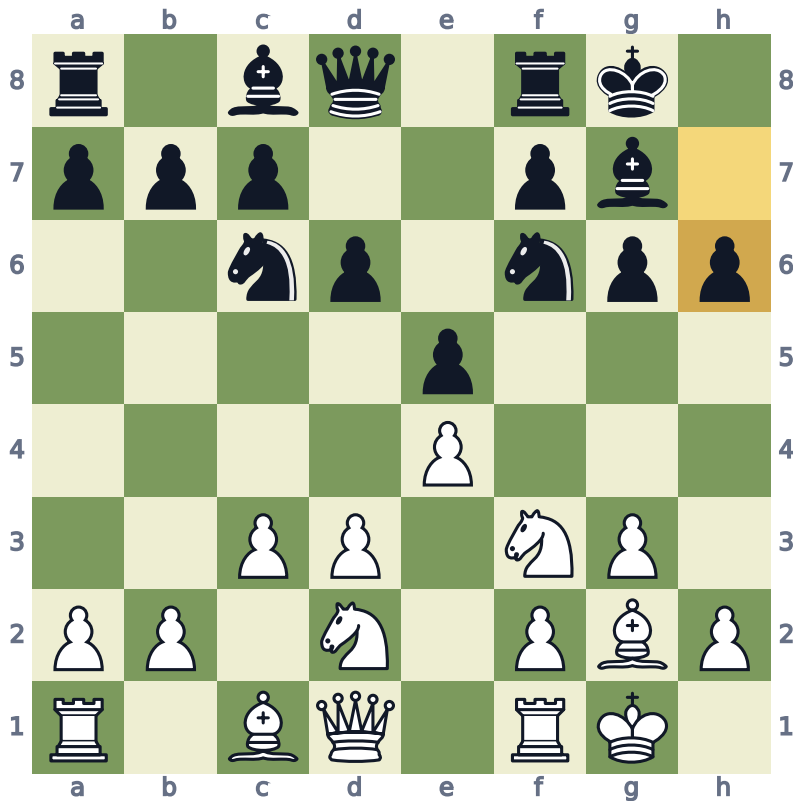
1. Qe2 reinforces e5, connects the rooks, and can reach h5 or g4, while staying behind the e-pawn and away from many minor-piece attacks. 2. Black attacks e5 with ...f6, opens the center against the queen, or gains queenside time before it reaches the king. 3. White uses Qe2 only when its dual central and attacking roles justify blocking the e-rook's line temporarily. 4. Will Qe2 help after ...f6, and which queen route remains safe after the center opens? 5. Moving the queen toward the attack while the e-file opens against it.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Qd2 and Bh6 against a fianchetto



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Against a kingside fianchetto, exchanging the g7 bishop can weaken dark squares, but the usual Bh6 route must fit the actual bishop placement and move order.

DECISION RULE

Does exchanging the fianchetto bishop create entry squares, or does it remove White's own useful attacking bishop?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black preserves the g7 bishop, challenges the center, and uses ...Bh3 or ...d5 before White completes a slow battery.

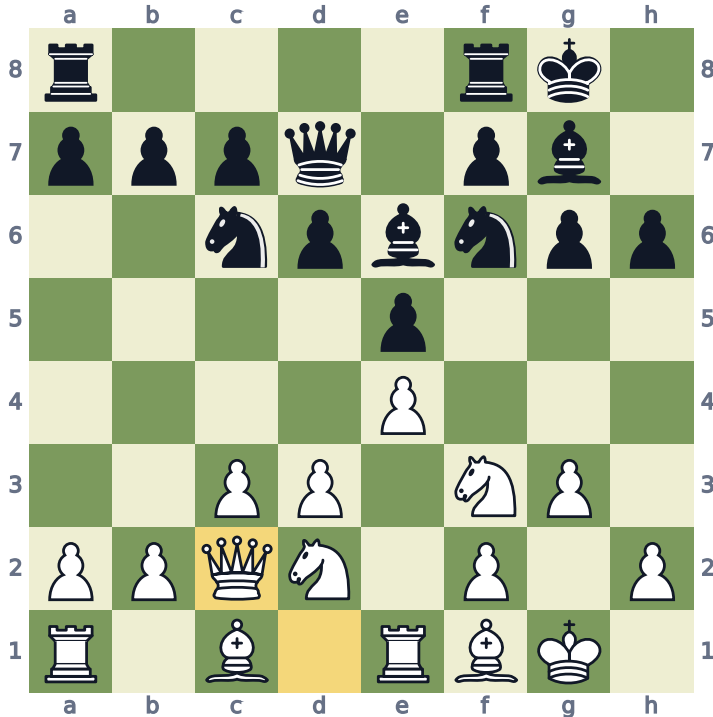
WHITE'S PLAN

White coordinates the dark bishop and queen, but switches plans if the exchange costs too many tempi or closes useful diagonals.

MEMORY RULE | Exchange a king defender only when the squares it guarded can be occupied.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White coordinates the dark bishop and queen, but switches plans if the exchange costs too many tempi or closes useful diagonals.

CUE

Against a kingside fianchetto, exchanging the g7 bishop can weaken dark squares, but the usual Bh6 route must fit the actual bishop placement and move order.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black preserves the g7 bishop, challenges the center, and uses ...Bh3 or ...d5 before White completes a slow battery.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

FAILURE MODE

Spending several moves to trade a bishop while Black seizes the center and the remaining pieces lack targets.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Does exchanging the fianchetto bishop create entry squares, or does it remove White's own useful attacking bishop? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

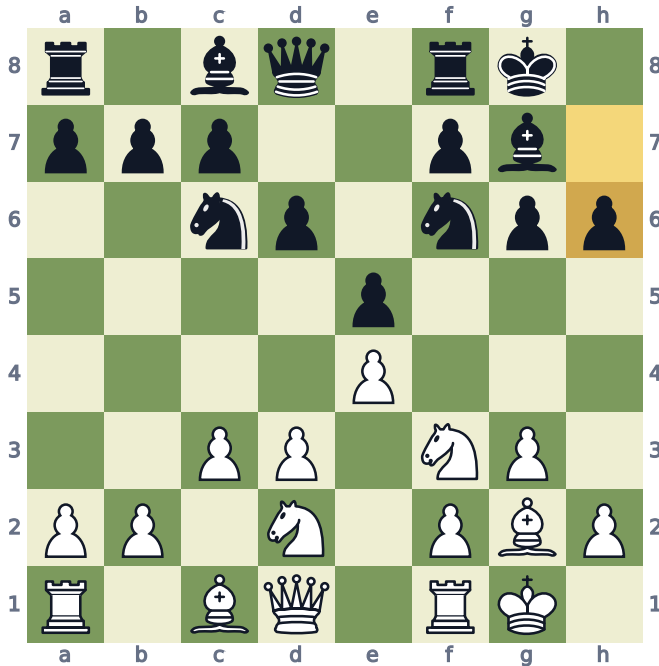
RULE | Exchange a king defender only when the squares it guarded can be occupied.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 g6 2. g3 Bg7 3. Bg2 d6 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 e5 7. e4 Nc6 8. c3 h6 9. Re1 Be6 10. Bf1 Qd7 11. Qc2



- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight to d2; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- e5: Black builds a symmetrical center that requires White to create a new pawn break.
- e4: White builds the KIA center but must account for Black's immediate central break.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- c3: White restrains d4 and prepares a central d4 break.
- h6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Against a kingside fianchetto, exchanging the g7 bishop can weaken dark squares, but the usual Bh6 route must fit the actual bishop placement and move order.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Does exchanging the fianchetto bishop create entry squares, or does it remove White's own useful attacking bishop? White's attacking or positional plan is: White coordinates the dark bishop and queen, but switches plans if the exchange costs too many tempi or closes useful diagonals. The line fails as a template when: Spending several moves to trade a bishop while Black seizes the center and the remaining pieces lack targets.

STORE THIS | Exchange a king defender only when the squares it guarded can be occupied.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

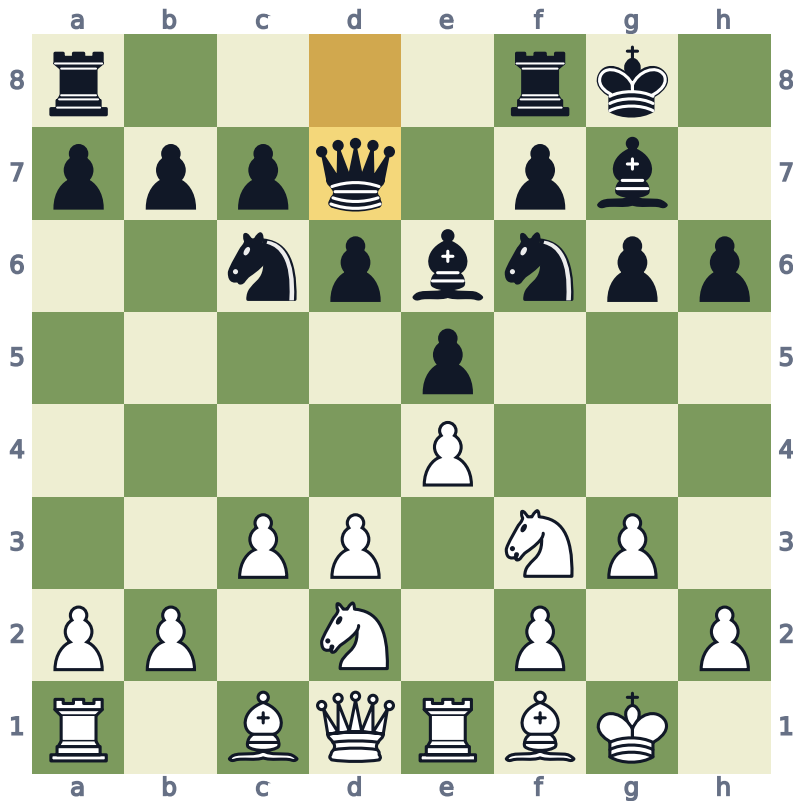
1. Against a kingside fianchetto, exchanging the g7 bishop can weaken dark squares, but the usual Bh6 route must fit the actual bishop placement and move order. 2. Black preserves the g7 bishop, challenges the center, and uses ...Bh3 or ...d5 before White completes a slow battery. 3. White coordinates the dark bishop and queen, but switches plans if the exchange costs too many tempi or closes useful diagonals. 4. Does exchanging the fianchetto bishop create entry squares, or does it remove White's own useful attacking bishop? 5. Spending several moves to trade a bishop while Black seizes the center and the remaining pieces lack targets.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Nbd2 e5 7. e4 Nc6 8. c3 h6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Qd2 and Bh6 against a fianchetto



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Against a kingside fianchetto, exchanging the g7 bishop can weaken dark squares, but the usual Bh6 route must fit the actual bishop placement and move order.

DECISION RULE

Does exchanging the fianchetto bishop create entry squares, or does it remove White's own useful attacking bishop?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black preserves the g7 bishop, challenges the center, and uses ...Bh3 or ...d5 before White completes a slow battery.

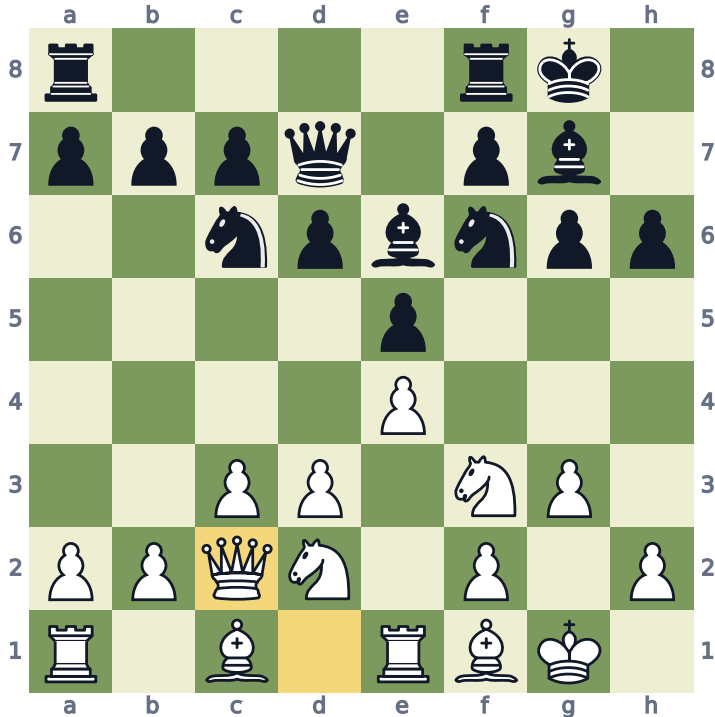
WHITE'S PLAN

White coordinates the dark bishop and queen, but switches plans if the exchange costs too many tempi or closes useful diagonals.

MEMORY RULE | Exchange a king defender only when the squares it guarded can be occupied.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Against a kingside fianchetto, exchanging the g7 bishop can weaken dark squares, but the usual Bh6 route must fit the actual bishop placement and move order.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black preserves the g7 bishop, challenges the center, and uses ...Bh3 or ...d5 before White completes a slow battery.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White coordinates the dark bishop and queen, but switches plans if the exchange costs too many tempi or closes useful diagonals.

FAILURE MODE

Spending several moves to trade a bishop while Black seizes the center and the remaining pieces lack targets.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Does exchanging the fianchetto bishop create entry squares, or does it remove White's own useful attacking bishop? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

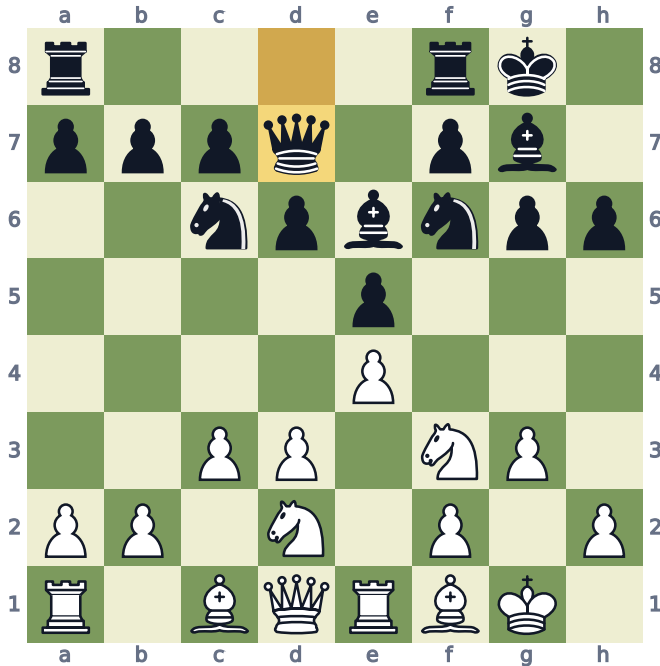
RULE | Exchange a king defender only when the squares it guarded can be occupied.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 g6 2. g3 Bg7 3. Bg2 d6 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 e5 7. e4 Nc6 8. c3 h6 9. Re1 Be6 10. Bf1 Qd7 11. Qc2



- c3: White restrains d4 and prepares a central d4 break.
- h6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- Be6: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- Bf1: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- Qd7: Black coordinates center and wing plans, but must check whether the queen becomes a tempo target.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Against a kingside fianchetto, exchanging the g7 bishop can weaken dark squares, but the usual Bh6 route must fit the actual bishop placement and move order.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Does exchanging the fianchetto bishop create entry squares, or does it remove White's own useful attacking bishop? White's attacking or positional plan is: White coordinates the dark bishop and queen, but switches plans if the exchange costs too many tempi or closes useful diagonals. The line fails as a template when: Spending several moves to trade a bishop while Black seizes the center and the remaining pieces lack targets.

STORE THIS | Exchange a king defender only when the squares it guarded can be occupied.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. Against a kingside fianchetto, exchanging the g7 bishop can weaken dark squares, but the usual Bh6 route must fit the actual bishop placement and move order. 2. Black preserves the g7 bishop, challenges the center, and uses ...Bh3 or ...d5 before White completes a slow battery. 3. White coordinates the dark bishop and queen, but switches plans if the exchange costs too many tempi or closes useful diagonals. 4. Does exchanging the fianchetto bishop create entry squares, or does it remove White's own useful attacking bishop? 5. Spending several moves to trade a bishop while Black seizes the center and the remaining pieces lack targets.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. c3 h6 9. Re1 Be6 10. Bf1 Qd7

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 043 Decode: Bf4 develops with purpose

Prompt: Which square will the bishop influence after Black's most forcing pawn challenge?

Recall: Develop the bishop to support the next break, not to complete a diagram.

LESSON 044 Play: Bf4 develops with purpose

Prompt: Which square will the bishop influence after Black's most forcing pawn challenge?

Recall: Develop the bishop to support the next break, not to complete a diagram.

LESSON 045 Decode: Qe2 supports the central rupture

Prompt: Will Qe2 help after ...f6, and which queen route remains safe after the center opens?

Recall: A good queen move serves the center and the king attack at the same time.

LESSON 046 Play: Qe2 supports the central rupture

Prompt: Will Qe2 help after ...f6, and which queen route remains safe after the center opens?

Recall: A good queen move serves the center and the king attack at the same time.

LESSON 047 Decode: Qd2 and Bh6 against a fianchetto

Prompt: Does exchanging the fianchetto bishop create entry squares, or does it remove White's own useful attacking bishop?

Recall: Exchange a king defender only when the squares it guarded can be occupied.

LESSON 048 Play: Qd2 and Bh6 against a fianchetto

Prompt: Does exchanging the fianchetto bishop create entry squares, or does it remove White's own useful attacking bishop?

Recall: Exchange a king defender only when the squares it guarded can be occupied.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's counterplay, White's plan, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

Bf4 develops with purpose

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. Bf4

Decision: Which square will the bishop influence after Black's most forcing pawn challenge?

Memory: Develop the bishop to support the next break, not to complete a diagram.

CARD 2

Qe2 supports the central rupture

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Qe2

Decision: Will Qe2 help after ...f6, and which queen route remains safe after the center opens?

Memory: A good queen move serves the center and the king attack at the same time.

CARD 3

Qd2 and Bh6 against a fianchetto

1. Nf3 g6 2. g3 Bg7 3. Bg2 d6 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 e5 7. e4 Nc6 8. c3 h6 9. Re1 Be6 10. Bf1 Qd7 11. Qc2

Decision: Does exchanging the fianchetto bishop create entry squares, or does it remove White's own useful attacking bishop?

Memory: Exchange a king defender only when the squares it guarded can be occupied.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
043 Decode: Bf4 develops with purpose	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
044 Play: Bf4 develops with purpose	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
045 Decode: Qe2 supports the central rupture	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
046 Play: Qe2 supports the central rupture	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
047 Decode: Qd2 and Bh6 against a fianchetto	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
048 Play: Qd2 and Bh6 against a fianchetto	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name Black's strongest counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.